26900321 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours)

REGULAR EXAMINATION OCTOBER 2026

FIFTH SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG5DSCJMC301 - DATA JOURNALISM

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Multiple Choice Questions

Answer all questions

Each question carries **1** marks

1. Which application best illustrates the use of data journalism in public-interest reporting? [A] / [CO1]

   a). Reporting only celebrity opinions | b).Reproducing an advertisement | c). Publishing an unverified rumour | d). Analysing government expenditure to identify unusual spending

2. Which is a major limitation of data journalism? [U] / [CO1]

   a). Data may be incomplete, inaccurate or difficult to interpret | b). Data never requires verification | c). All datasets are equally reliable | d). Data always provides objective conclusions

3. A journalist compares government spending across five years and discovers a substantial unexplained increase. The data primarily functions as a tool for [A] / [CO1]

   a). Avoiding verification | b). Producing fictional content | c). Replacing interviews | d). Generating investigative questions

4. What does data privacy primarily concern? [K] / [CO3]

a). Design of charts b). Calculation of averages c). Organisation of headlines d). Protection of personal information

5. Which is an important first step when verifying a dataset? [An] / [CO3]

a). Changing the values b). Removing the source details c). Checking the original source d). Publishing the data immediately

6. Which feature can be used to represent data visually? [K] / [CO3]

a). Folder b). File name c). Chart d). Comment

7. What is the main purpose of summarising data? [A] / [CO3]

a). To increase the size of the dataset b). To collect new data c). To present important information clearly d). To hide numerical values

8. Which practice is unethical in data journalism? [An] / [CO5]

a). Checking calculations b). Citing data sources c). Explaining limitations d). Manipulating data

9. Investigative data journalism primarily uses data to [U] / [CO6]

a). Support evidence-based investigation and reporting b). Replace the need for verification

c). Reduce the importance of sources d). Avoid interpretation

10. Which factor should receive the greatest consideration when selecting data for reporting a sensitive social issue? [E] / [CO6]

a). Sensational value b). Accuracy, context and ethical implications c). Visual attractiveness d). Size of the dataset

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

Short Answer Type Questions

Answer any **10** questions

Each question carries **3** marks

11. How does data help journalists identify patterns and trends? [U] / [CO1]

12. Describe the basic statistical techniques used by journalists to analyse data. [K] / [CO3]

13. Explain the importance of different varieties of data in journalism. [U] / [CO3]

14. Explain how the Right to Information (RTI) Act is utilized by data journalists to acquire public data. [K] / [CO5]

15. State the meaning of Volume in the context of data. [K] / [CO3]

16. Define data organisation in the context of journalism. [K] / [CO3]

17. List any four principles of effective data visualization. [U] / [CO4]

18. How would you select a suitable data visualisation tool for a news story? [U] / [CO4]

19. How can a journalist extract useful information from a PDF report? [E] / [CO4]

20. How would you use web scraping to collect information from multiple web pages? [E] / [CO6]

21. How can a journalist identify misleading patterns in a dataset? [E] / [CO6]

22. Propose a data-driven investigative story and explain the data sources you would use. [C] / [CO6]

[3x10 = 30]

Part C

Essay Type Questions

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

23. Discuss the major concepts of Data Journalism and explain how they enhance the accuracy and credibility of a news story. [U] / [CO1]

24. Explain how data-driven storytelling can transform an ordinary story into an engaging news story. [K] / [CO2]

25. Evaluate the importance of simplifying complex data without changing its original meaning. [An] / [CO3]

26. Evaluate the role of data journalism in investigating social issues such as poverty, unemployment, education, crime and public health. [E] / [CO6]

[15x2 = 30]